

Researchers asked 100 Americans to describe their recollections of the September 11, 2001, terrorist attacks at two time points: 2 days and 10 years after the attacks. Comparing the descriptions for each individual, researchers are LEAST likely to find that:

- ☐ A. individuals are extremely confident in their memories, even 10 years after the attacks. [4%]
- ✓ ☒ B. individuals' recollections are extremely accurate 10 years after the attacks. [72%]
- ☐ C. individuals vividly recall seemingly insignificant details from the day of the attacks. [16%]
- ☐ D. individuals vividly recall their emotional reactions to the events of that day. [6%]

Correct

73% answered correctly

Explanation:

Flashbulb memory	
Produced by events that are:	Memory characteristics:
↑ Emotional	↑ Vivid
↑ Important	↑ Detailed
↑ Personal	↑ Confidence in memory
↑ Distinct	Questionable accuracy

A **flashbulb memory** is a **vivid, detailed** type of autobiographical **explicit memory** for an event that was extremely **emotional, distinct**, or **significant** to the individual. Flashbulb memories occur not only for negative events (eg, 9/11), but also for positive events (eg, the birth of a child). It is easier to use national events, such as the 9/11 terrorist attacks, to study flashbulb memory.

Once thought to be extremely accurate snapshots (hence the term "flashbulb") of emotionally arousing events, studies suggest that flashbulb memories may be **less accurate/consistent** than individuals believe. People tend to be extremely confident of their recollections, even though their flashbulb memories are not 100% accurate or consistent over time.

Flashbulb memories are defined by the following characteristics:

- Individuals feel extremely confident about the memory, even after a long time has elapsed (**Choice A**).
- Individuals are able to vividly recall specific details surrounding the event, including ones of seeming insignificance, such as what one was wearing or doing at the time of the event (**Choice C**).
- Individuals are able to vividly recall their emotional state at the time of the event (**Choice D**).

Educational objective:

Flashbulb memories are vivid, detailed autobiographical memories of an event that was extremely emotional or distinct or personally significant. Flashbulb memories may be best defined by the degree to which individuals feel confident about their recollections, even when the recollections are not completely accurate or consistent over time.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:401303

System:

Learning, Memory, and Cognition

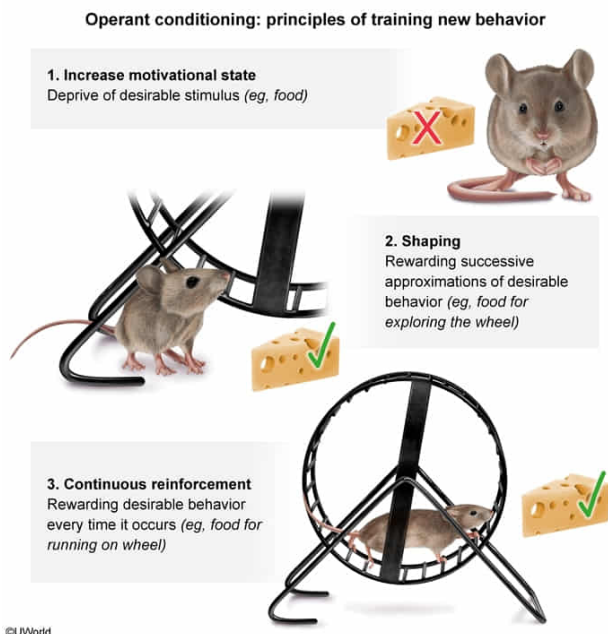
A researcher wants to train a mouse to run on an exercise wheel. The LEAST effective way to train this new behavior would involve:

- ☐ A. rewarding the mouse at first for touching the wheel, then for climbing on it, then for running on it. [6%]
- ✓ ☒ B. providing reinforcement every 5 minutes, as long as the mouse runs on the wheel at some point during that time. [57%]
- ☐ C. first depriving the mouse of food for 24 hours, then using food pellets as a reward. [33%]
- ☐ D. providing positive reinforcement each time the mouse runs on the exercise wheel. [3%]

Correct

56% answered correctly

Explanation:



In **operant conditioning**, reinforcement is used to encourage certain behaviors, and punishment is used to discourage unwanted behaviors. Reinforcement (eg, rewarding desirable behavior with food) tends to be more effective than punishment. Furthermore, providing a reward *after every single desired behavior*, known as **continuous reinforcement**, is the **best way to train** animals to perform a **new behavior**.

In operant conditioning, **partial reinforcement schedules** provide reinforcement after a certain number of behaviors (ratio) or amount of time (interval). The schedules are either fixed (consistent) or variable (inconsistent). Partial reinforcement schedules are best used to **maintain behaviors** that have already

been learned through continuous reinforcement.

Rewarding the mouse after some amount of time has passed is a fixed (ie, consistent) interval (ie, time-based) reinforcement schedule. A fixed interval reinforcement schedule is not an optimal way to train an animal to perform a new behavior because it is more difficult for the animal to associate the desired behavior with the reward.

(Choice A) When first training an animal to perform a new behavior, it is often necessary to reward successive approximations of the desired behavior, known as shaping. Rewarding the mouse for behaviors that increasingly resemble the desired response (eg, touching the wheel, climbing on it, running on it) would be an appropriate strategy during training.

(Choice C) During the training phase, the best way to increase the desirability of the food reward is to deprive the mouse of food for a certain period before training. This greatly increases the motivational state of the animal, making it more likely to respond to a food reward during training.

(Choice D) Continuous reinforcement (eg, rewarding the mouse each time it runs on the exercise wheel) is the *best way to condition new behavior*.

Educational objective:

A continuous reinforcement schedule, which provides a reward after every desired behavior, is most effective for training an animal to perform a new behavior. Shaping (ie, rewarding successive approximations of the desired behavior) is often needed initially. Depriving the animal of the reward (eg, food) prior to training heightens its motivation, making training easier.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:401304

System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition